

Statement of Interest

Wealth of Nations at 250 — Rapporteur Application

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Contributor preferences: (1) Besley & Ghatak (2) Rodrik (3) Voth

I am a PhD candidate in Economic History at the London School of Economics, funded by the ESRC. My dissertation examines sovereign debt and political institutions across the first age of globalisation, combining archival research with computational text analysis and panel econometrics.

My preferred assignments are Besley and Ghatak, Rodrik, and Voth, and the fit in each case is direct. My paper “Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875–1885”, prepared for the Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop (June 2026), applies Morgan’s models as mediators framework to show how the gold standard operated in nineteenth-century Greek politics: not as a self-enforcing commitment mechanism but as a model whose authority depended on narrative embedding as much as technical demonstration. This puts me in close engagement with the questions Besley and Ghatak raise about the interplay between values, narrative, and economic institutions: their chapter on moral sentiments in market economies addresses exactly the mechanisms I reconstruct from the Greek parliamentary record. A companion paper on Greek legislative behaviour (1875–1905) uses 755 roll call votes to test whether fiscal shocks shift legislators from clientelist to programmatic behaviour, which is the question Besley and Ghatak address from the theoretical side: when do values and motivated agents reshape economic institutions rather than adapt to them?

Rodrik’s chapter raises the question of contextual versus universal application of economic ideas, which is the core of my paper’s misapplication claim: the critics of Greece’s gold standard adoption were technically correct, and they lost not because they were wrong but because they lacked a counter-model with comparable narrative authority. In Rodrik’s terms, the critics were making a proto-mercantilist case, prioritising contextual fit over universal principle, without a framework capable of matching the gold standard’s civilisational authority.

Voth’s chapter on conflict, colonialism, and the wealth of nations connects to my research on debt restructuring under the Ottoman Public Debt Administration, the Egyptian Caisse de la Dette, and the Greek International Financial Commission, where I study the fiscal infrastructure question from the borrower side using bond-level London Stock Exchange data. All three supervisory regimes followed military defeat and forced fiscal restructuring; my difference-in-differences estimates show significant yield spread convergence in each case, consistent with Voth’s argument that conflict-driven institutional change reshaped credit conditions for generations.

As a teaching assistant for EC311 (History of Economic Thought) at LSE, I regularly explain how economic ideas develop, travel, and are contested across time, which is the same task a rapporteur proceedings chapter performs for a conference contribution. I have presented my own research at WEHC (Lund, 2025) and the WEAI Annual Conference (San Francisco, 2025), and I write for audiences across economic history, political economy, and the history of economic thought.

Having active papers in each of the areas these chapters address, I would engage with the contributions as a researcher, not only as a note-taker. I attach my CV and a letter of support from my supervisor, Professor Albrecht Ritschl.

Education

University Education

- 09/2024– Present **MPhil/PhD Economic History**, *London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)*, London, UK
- Supervised by Professors Albrecht Ritschl and Olivier Accominotti, with doctoral research on sovereign debt, monetary politics, and political institutions in late 19th-century Greece
 - Selected for the ESRC-funded PhD Studentship, after turning down a place at Oxford University
 - Methods training in quantitative text analysis and applied deep learning for social science
 - Combining archival sources, parliamentary proceedings, and bond-level market data in historical research
- 09/2022– 06/2024 **MSc Financial History**, *LSE*, London, UK
- Distinction (inaugural cohort), completed part-time alongside full-time employment
 - Modules in time series econometrics and history of global finance, with project work in R & Stata
 - Dissertation on sovereign debt using textual analysis, supervised by Prof. Albrecht Ritschl (82%)
 - Runner-up, MSc Financial History Dissertation Prize; nominated for the department's working paper series
- 09/2015– 06/2018 **BSc Economics**, *LSE*, London, UK
- Advised by Prof. Silvana Tenreyro, external member of the Bank of England's Monetary Policy Committee
 - Distinction in 6 of 12 modules, including Economic History, Principles of Economics, and Finance

Other Education

- 04/2026– 06/2026 **PhD Course in “Empire, Trade, and Divergence in the Long 19th Century”**, Gothenburg, Sweden
- Doctoral course taught by Prof. Markus Lampe (WU Vienna); covers political economy of empire, international trade, migration, and investment in the long nineteenth century (1770s–1930s)
 - Combines online and in-person sessions; includes a 20–25 minute research presentation with a 2-page handout
- 10/2025– 06/2026 **Principles of Teaching in Higher Education (TC501)**, *LSE Eden Centre*, London, UK
- Built around EC311: two seminar groups over 21 teaching weeks with three rounds of formative essay marking
 - Developmental observation by Alex Standen PFHEA and disciplinary review by Cléo Chassonnery-Zaïgouche
 - AdvanceHE-accredited route to AFHEA, with reflective journal and teaching portfolio
- 09/2023 **Economics Summer School**, *University of Oxford*, Oxford, UK
- Presented MSc dissertation research on sovereign debt in an Oxford monetary economics seminar
 - Studied machine learning under Prof. Maximilian Kasy, including PAC learning and deep neural networks
 - Applied machine-learning methods in Python/scikit-learn, bridging quantitative and historical research
- 09/2011– 06/2015 **IB Diploma**, *St. Catherine's British (Embassy) School*, Athens, Greece
- Graduated tied 1st in class and in the top 1% worldwide in the IB Diploma (44/45)
 - Achieved 7s in Higher Level Maths and Physics, as part of a quantitatively focused course load

Research Experience

- 02/2026– Present **Research Assistant**, *Hellenic Observatory*, *LSE*, London, UK
- **Bank of Greece Partnership**
 - Co-author (with Monastiriotes & Chrysafis-Protopoulos) of “Measuring AI Exposure in the Greek Labour Market: A Comparative Analysis of Occupational Indices and Survey Evidence”, a communication from the Hellenic Observatory to the Department of Economic Analysis and Research, Bank of Greece
 - Assembled a harmonised dataset of AI occupational exposure indices from the international literature, mapped to ISCO-08 via crosswalk, and covering both potentiality-based and revealed-use approaches
 - Reviewed survey evidence on AI adoption, attitudes, and workforce readiness in Greece
 - Planned Research in Practice placement (July–September 2026) at Bank of Greece to continue project
 - **Other Projects**
 - Supporting Dr. Laliotis & Minos on “Economic Incentives and Vaccination”, building a corpus of Greek regional news coverage and processing Cirium aviation arrivals data to measure the UK tourism demand shock at NUTS-3 level
 - Supporting Prof. Monastiriotes on a comparative industrial-policy project on small EU member states (Denmark, Portugal, Greece, and Latvia), contributing to source synthesis, draft-paper development, comparative analysis, fact-checking, bibliography preparation, tables, and visualisation design

- 01/2026– **Research Assistant, Professor Sir Rick Trainor (EHS Centenary Grant), LSE, London, UK**
 04/2026
- Primary researcher for Trainor's centenary paper "Whatever Happened to Social History? Social History in the Work of the Economic History Society, 1926–2026", presented at the EHS Centenary Conference (April 2026)
 - Reviewed and synthesised un-digitised EHS Council minutes, AGM reports, and committee records (1926–2010) at the LSE Library; negotiated access to restricted materials via LSE Reader Services and current EHS leadership
 - Classified 200+ articles from the *Economic History Review* and EHS conference programmes across 10 sample years (1927–2019) by topic and methodology to map century-long disciplinary trends
 - Drafted the conference abstract, presentation deck, and speaker notes delivered at the conference
- 11/2025– **Research Assistant, Prof. Almudena Sevilla, LSE Department of Social Policy, London, UK**
 07/2026
- Building Employment Tribunal dataset on discrimination in higher education institutions
 - Web scraping, data cleaning, and AI-assisted extraction (Gemini) of case details and outcomes
- 09/2023– **Research Assistant, Professor Albrecht Ritschl, LSE, London, UK**
 06/2024
- Recalculated monetary aggregates in Germany during the Great Depression for a book in progress
 - Conducted archival research on practices to curb hyperinflation in Nazi-occupied Greece

Teaching Experience

- 10/2024– **Teaching Assistant, LSE Economic History Department, London, UK**
 Present
- EC311 (History of Economics: How Theories Change, conv. Dr. Cléo Chassonnery-Zaïgouche): lead two weekly seminar groups (21 teaching weeks); mark three rounds of formative essays and provide written feedback; received two formal teaching observations (Eden Centre and departmental)
 - EC204 (History of Bubbles, Crashes and Inflations, conv. Profs. Ritschl, Accominotti & Dr. Lennard): led two class groups in LSE Summer School (June–July 2025, 3 weeks); marked formative, mid-session, and final exams
 - EH390 (Stata Workshops), EH101 and EH102: additional teaching and marking duties across courses
- 10/2024– **GTA Mentee, LSE Economic History Department, London, UK**
 06/2025
- Shadowed and co-taught six seminars across two terms (EH101 & EH102) with mentors G. Salter and A. Park
 - Departmental GTA Mentoring Scheme coordinated by Prof. Neil Cummins

Professional Experience

Tech

- 01/2024– **Founder Associate, Operations, Genie (acquired by Doss in July 2025), London, UK**
 06/2025
- Built the financial model, investor updates, and data room for fundraising and investor reporting
 - Researched acquirer targets, built outreach lists, and drafted acquisition materials that contributed to the sale
 - Led all-hands, offsites, salary reviews, and recruitment as acting people-operations lead
 - Redesigned customer-support, merchant-onboarding, and internal data workflows to reduce turnaround times
- 05/2021– **Operations Manager, Clausematch (acquired by Corlytics in July 2023), London, UK**
 07/2023
- Managed the data room, diligence workflows, and investor requests across two company funding rounds
 - Owned board decks, investor updates, and all-hands materials for company-wide and external reporting
 - Led recruitment, onboarding, and people operations in a 70+ person scaling company across teams
- 06/2019– **Intern, Finance Team, N26 (Neobank, raised \$300M Series D from Insight and GIC), Berlin, Germany**
 12/2019
- Prepared board reporting on Group performance, sourcing and modelling operating and financial data
 - Built bottom-up revenue models and business cases for new product launches and existing products

Finance

- 08/2020– **Visiting Analyst, Investment Team, Creandum (Early-stage VC), Stockholm, Sweden**
 12/2020
- Conducted customer interviews and market diligence for live SafetyWing, Craft, and lemon.markets deals
 - Worked across Series A, Seed, and Pre-Seed opportunities in insurtech, enterprise software, and fintech
 - Built relationships with CEE investors and sourced startup leads and founder introductions across the region
- 03/2020– **Visiting Analyst, Chief Investment Office, Speedinvest (Seed-stage VC), Vienna, Austria**
 07/2020
- Built the GP's internal fund model for allocation optimisation and scenario analysis across portfolio deployment
 - Drafted institutional LP due-diligence responses during fundraising, including for the EIF
 - Conducted portfolio-based research on startup board composition, governance, and their importance
- 09/2018– **Off-Cycle Analyst, FIG Banking, Morgan Stanley (Multinational investment bank), London, UK**
 02/2019
- Prepared board and client materials for Benelux and EME FIG mandates, including Ethniki Insurance and eFront
 - Supported live M&A and NPL mandates, including a €1.5bn reinsurer deal and a €3bn NPL portfolio
- 06/2017– **Intern (Analyst), AnaCap Financial Partners (Private equity firm focused on fin. services), London, UK**
 08/2017
- Built models for heidelpay, Barclays France, and NPLs across Private Equity and Credit Opportunities
 - Prepared teasers, IC packs, offer letters, and diligence materials for live PE and credit deals

Research Interests

Core Themes

Sovereign Debt; Financial Markets; Political Institutions; First Age of Globalisation; Text-as-Data; LLMs; History of Economic Thought

Thesis Projects

- “From War Finance to Fiscal Supervision: Seniority Structures and Debt Restructuring in the Ottoman Empire, Egypt, and Greece, 1870–1907” (draft). First comparative empirical analysis of supervisory regimes (OPDA, Caisse de la Dette, IFC) using bond-level London Stock Exchange data. DiD estimates show significant yield spread compression across all three cases; Greek case shows yield spread inversion driven by state-contingent coupons; proposes minimal extension to Ho–Ritschl (2024) seniority reversal model.
- “Permeable Patronage: Fiscal Crises and Domain-Specific Defection in the Greek Parliament, 1875–1905” (draft). Tests whether fiscal shocks produce programmatic legislative transitions using 755 nominal roll call votes (132,246 MP–vote observations, 1,049 MPs) linked to a biographical registry and classified by policy domain across eight political shocks. After the 1893 default, Peloponnesian MPs defect significantly more on taxation but not on non-fiscal votes. Adapts Krehbiel’s identification problem to clientelist legislatures via π -pattern/ π -binding decomposition.
- “Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875–1885” (draft, prepared for Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop, June 2026). Reconstructs parliamentary debates using newly digitised Hellenic Parliament proceedings. Argues the gold standard operated as a “model” (Morgan’s sense) whose authority depended on narrative embedding; the central claim is *misapplication* rather than wrong theory. Maps eleven parliamentarians across constitutional, distributional, regional, and technical registers; analyses absence of bimetallism as counter-narrative.
- “Sterling by Design: Contractual Standardisation and Currency Dominance on the London Stock Exchange, 1869–1929”. Security-level panel of 957 sovereign debt instruments (IMM). Sterling’s share of income flows rose substantially as multi-currency clauses, bullion clauses, and non-sterling denominations were eliminated. Bai–Perron breaks in late 1870s–1880s precede periphery gold adoption; captive borrowers paid a significant yield premium over outside-option borrowers.

Outside Interests

- “Made in Greece or Echoed from Europe? Sentiment and Awareness Among International Partners During the 1931–1932 Greek Sovereign Debt Crisis” (draft). Employs a novel LLM-based text-as-data approach on the Tsouderos Archive (private correspondence of the Bank of Greece Governor) to map sentiment and topic trends in communications with foreign officials. Identifies two structural breaks (June and September 1931) via change point analysis; SVAR shows a significant negative relationship between archive sentiment and Greek bond yields.
- “Whatever Happened to Social History? Social History in the Work of the Economic History Society, 1926–2026” (with Prof. Sir Rick Trainor, LSE). Examines the EHS’s century-long relationship with social history using un-digitised Council minutes, AGM records, and sampled *Economic History Review* articles and conference programmes (1927–2019). Finds thematic persistence of social topics (labour, demography, health, gender) alongside a methodological shift toward quantitative methods; the journal and conference diverged in approach while converging on the same subjects. Presented at the EHS Centenary Conference (April 2026).
- “Why Did Depositors Run? Withdrawals in the German Banking Crisis of 1931” (with Philip Fliers, Queen’s University Belfast). Bimonthly bank-level balance sheets (1925–1935). Severe withdrawals were widespread, highly predictable up to two years prior, and differed systematically across maturities. Withdrawals accompanied by substantial deposit reallocation across banks.

Academic Activity

Conferences

- EHS Annual Conference (London, UK, 04/2026): Paper Presentation
- WEHC (Lund, Sweden, 07/2025): Poster Presentation
- WEAI 100th Annual Conference (San Francisco, CA, 06/2025): Paper Presentation

Workshops

- Machine Learning and Big Data in Economic History (Hohenheim, Germany, 02/2026): Paper Presentation
- EHS Residential Training Course (Radcliffe House, University of Warwick, UK, 12/2025): Paper Presentation
- SMGS Graduate Research Colloquium (Reading, UK, 05/2025): Paper Presentation
- YSI-EHES Economic History Graduate Webinar Series (Virtual, 05/2025): Paper Presentation

Seminars

- Hellenic Observatory Research Seminar (LSE, 12/2025): Paper Presentation
- DSI PhD Affiliate Research Spotlight (LSE, 11/2025): Paper Presentation
- DSI PhD Affiliate Lightning Talks (LSE, 02/2025): Presentation

Academic Positions

- 01/2026– **Inaugural DTP Student Representative**, *LSE ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership*, London, UK
Present
 - Appointed to inaugural student representation role within the LSE ESRC DTP, selected for dual perspective as LSESU PGR Officer and ESRC-funded doctoral researcher
 - Attend termly DTP Management Committee meetings; developing approaches to gathering and responding to student perspectives within DTP governance
- 10/2025– **GTA Officer**, *LSESU*, London, UK
Present
 - Representing Graduate Teaching Assistants in university governance; attending senior LSE committees including the Research Degrees Sub-committee (RDSC), Research Students' Consultative Forum, and Academic Board
 - Working with UCU on campus advocacy; leading UKRI stipend campaign with other unions; coordinating GTA contract mapping across 25 LSE departments
- 10/2025– **Writing Advisor**, *LSE Economic History Department*, London, UK
Present
 - Providing writing advice sessions to undergraduate students
 - Monitoring student welfare alongside academic support
- 09/2025– **LSE Graduate Economic History Seminar**, *LSE*, London, UK
Present
 - Co-convenor of weekly PhD seminar series (Autumn 2025), managing applications and program organization
 - Outreach to international academic networks and manage seminar logistics for diverse participant pool

Academic Affiliations

- 12/2024– **PhD Affiliate**, **Data Science Institute**, *LSE*, London, UK
Present
 - Part of an inter-disciplinary network that holds research seminars and workshops on machine learning applications
- 12/2024– **Doctoral Affiliate**, **Hellenic Observatory**, *LSE*, London, UK
Present
 - One of two doctoral candidates selected for the inaugural 2024/25 pilot scheme
 - Allocated a mentor from senior members, and research budget for conferences

Political Affiliations

- 03/2026– **Member, Central Political Committee**, *PASOK (Panhellenic Socialist Movement)*, Athens, Greece
Present
 - PASOK is Greece's official (main) opposition party, with over 174,000 active members as of March 2026
 - Elected at the 4th Regular Congress with 335 votes, from circa 5,500 delegates, to the 271-member committee
 - The Central Political Committee elects the Secretary and the 23-member Political Council, implements congress decisions, and holds the party leadership accountable between congresses
 - Third (and youngest) of the five diaspora delegates elected to the committee, representing England
- 08/2023– **Municipal Council Candidate**, *dimos Mprosta+ (Lykovrysi–Pefki municipal slate)*, Athens, Greece
10/2023
 - Part of the slate led by Marios Psychalis, which won the October 2023 local elections and elected him Mayor of Lykovrysi–Pefki with 54%; platform focused on everyday issues, schools, green space, and social policy
 - Received 102 preference votes as a candidate for municipal councillor in the Pefki municipal unit (pop. 21,292)
 - Municipal Council votes on budgets, local regulations, procurement, and public-works priorities, scrutinises the municipal administration, and represents residents

Awards

- 09/2024– **ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership (DTP) Award**, *LSE*, London, UK
06/2028
 - Selected for prestigious fully-funded studentship covering tuition fees and maintenance stipend
- 12/2024 **Runner-up, MSc Financial History Dissertation Prize**, *LSE*, London, UK
○ Highly recommended for the MSc Financial History Dissertation Prize
○ Dissertation eligible for publication in the LSE Economic History student working paper series
- 05/2015 **Winner, Generation Euro Students' Award**, *European Central Bank (ECB)*, Frankfurt, Germany
○ Awarded first place in a Euro-wide team competition on monetary policy, received prize from Mario Draghi
○ Led a group of 5 students that predicted the ECB's decision during tense Greek government negotiations

Skills

- Languages Greek (Native), English (Native), German (studying for B2)
- Technical Python, R, Stata, SQL, JavaScript; pandas, scikit-learn, tidyverse; Excel



To Professors

Alex Trew

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Department of
Economic History

Dear colleagues

06 April 2026

Recommendation for Aris Grivokostopoulos, LSE

Rapporteur expression of interest

I am writing in enthusiastic support of the application of my student Aristeidis Grivokostopoulos for the rapporteur position at the Wealth of Nations at 250 conference at Glasgow in October.

Aris joined the LSE Economic History PhD programme in September 2024, funded by an ESRC DTP studentship. He is a second-year PhD student with four working papers in circulation, conference presentations at WEHC (Lund, 2025) and the WEAI Annual Conference (San Francisco, 2025), and affiliations with the LSE Data Science Institute and the Hellenic Observatory. His research is directly relevant to all three of his preferred assignments.

Aris' paper "Between Civilisation and Constitution: Greek Parliamentary Debates on Gold Standard Adoption, 1875-1885", prepared for the Mary Morgan Retirement Workshop (June 2026), applies Morgan's models-as-mediators framework to show how economic ideas fail when applied without their institutional preconditions. This research connects directly to the questions Besley and Ghatak raise about values and institutions and to Rodrik's argument about contextual versus universal economic policy. A companion paper uses 755 roll call votes to test whether fiscal shocks shift legislators from clientelist to programmatic behaviour, extending the same institutional analysis to the legislative level.

Aris' work on sovereign debt restructuring in the Ottoman Empire, Egypt, and Greece uses bond-level London Stock Exchange data to estimate the credit market effects of war-driven

fiscal supervision. This connects directly to the fiscal infrastructure questions at the heart of Voth's chapter on the infrastructure-building properties of war finance.

Aris is a good writer producing texts for audiences across economic history and the history of economic thought, and also teaches for EC311 (History of Economic Thought) at LSE.

I support his application most strongly and without reservations. Please do not hesitate to get back to me with any queries.

Yours faithfully,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading 'Albrecht Ritschl'. The signature is written in a cursive style with a large, stylized 'A' and a long, sweeping underline.

Albrecht Ritschl
Professor